There seemed to me something unique about the continuity of a cultural tradition through five thousand years of history, of invasion and upheaval, a tradition which was widespread among the masses a n d powerfully influenced them. Only China has had such a continuity of tradition and cultural life. And this panorama of the past gradually merged into the unhappy present, when India, for all her past greatness and stability, was a slave country, an appendage of Britain, and all over the world terrible and devastating war was raging and brutalizing humanity. But that vision of five thousand years gave me a new perspective, and the burden of the present seemed to grow lighter.

T h e hundred and eighty years of British rule in India were just one of the unhappy interludes in her long story; she would find herself again; already the last page of this chapter was being written. T h e world also will survive the horror of to-day and build itself anew on fresh foundations.

N a t i o n a l i s m and I n t e r n a t i o n a l i s m

My reaction to India thus was often an emotional one, conditioned and limited in m a n y ways. It took the form of nationalism. In the case of many people the conditioning and limiting